

Attachment 9

Description of Participant Recruitment

To Renounce Liberty? A Public-Goods Experiment on (Un)Democratic Reversal

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Population and selection

The target is 300 adults who complete the experiment, recruited through the University of Turku PCRC Decision Laboratory participant pool for sessions planned between 1 and 31 October 2026. Eligibility is limited to people aged 18 or older who can understand the study language and attend the full approximately 60-minute session. No political opinion, prior game experience, academic field, or expected choice is used as a selection criterion.

PCRC will distribute the approved neutral advertisement through TOKA and its usual scheduling channels. Interested individuals voluntarily book an available session. The interactive task requires a completed roster divisible by five. Ten-person matching pools are formed first; when the largest usable roster ends in 15, one fifteen-person pool is formed. Thus, 10, 15, 20, 25, or 30 participants can enter paid play, producing one to three matching pools. If 1–4 additional people arrive, PCRC applies its normal arrival-order and compensation rules and releases the surplus before paid play. No participant enters or changes matching pools after the task begins. Duplicate participation is prevented through normal laboratory scheduling records.

Recruitment and scheduling information is administered separately from experimental responses. PCRC retains the identifying information needed for attendance and payment and gives researchers only coded experimental data. Its temporary identity-to-code link is deleted when payment is complete. No teacher, employer, or direct supervisor will recruit subordinates, and participation or refusal will not affect studies, employment, grades, services, or future eligibility for unrelated research.

Information and consent procedure

The invitation gives the study location, duration, broad topic, eligibility, and expected payment without disclosing directional hypotheses. TOKA members have already accepted PCRC's general laboratory rules and TOKA privacy notice. Before any practice or paid task, oTree presents concise project-specific information, the location of the research privacy notice, and Janne Tukiainen's contact details. Participants may ask the researcher or laboratory manager questions.

The same first oTree screen records a short study-specific confirmation. Participants affirm that they are at least 18, have read the study information, understand the duration, interaction, payment, risks, and coded-data arrangements, and voluntarily agree to participate. The system records the response, form version, date, and time. This confirmation supplements rather than replaces the TOKA-level agreement. A person who does not agree does not enter the interactive task. The laboratory manager then finalises or relaunches the roster so that only consenting participants and complete five-person groups enter Block 1.

Participants may stop later without giving a reason. Because the task is synchronized, they are asked to notify the laboratory manager, who manages the interruption without generating a decision or allowing another person to inherit their experimental history. The fixed participation payment and any performance earnings are handled under the approved laboratory procedure. Data already collected are processed as stated in the privacy notice.

Compensation and follow-up

Participants receive EUR 10 plus a points-based performance bonus of up to EUR 5, determined by one randomly selected round from each block. The maximum total payment is EUR 15. Payment administration and any legally required reporting information remain separate from research responses. PCRC deletes the identity-to-code link after payment; researchers cannot subsequently use the coded dataset to identify a participant. No additional contact is planned after payment.